

Ārya-buddha-hṛdaya-nāma-dhārāṇī-dharmaparyāya · Toh 854 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སངས་རྒྱལ་གྱི་དྲི་པ་ཞེས་བཟུང་གི་ཐད་སྤྲུལ་གྱི་ཆོས་ཀྱི་རྩམས་

In the language of India: Ārya-buddha-hṛdaya-nāma-dhāraṇī-dharma-paryāya.
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Heart of the Buddhas, a Dharma Discourse
in the form of a Dhāraṇī.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the forest hermitage of the Dharma, the domain of the Tathāgatas, in the courtyard of the Jewel-Adorned Assembly, a place of discernment by primordial wisdom, blessed by the buddhas of the past, praised by all beings, endowed with the supreme of all the abodes of the great bodhisattvas, a place that accords with the equality of all phenomena. In the midst of the all-radiant, excellent palace there were countless billions upon billions of bodhisattvas, every one of them prophesied to awakening, every one gathered from a different world-system, every one a child of the Tathāgata, the King of Dharma, and every one possessed of a variety of dhāraṇīs and meditative absorptions. Surrounded by this great host, the Blessed One sat facing them, upon a single seat, and taught the Dharma.

Then the Blessed One addressed the vast assembly of bodhisattvas: Sons of noble family, for the benefit of the many, for the happiness of the many, out of compassion for the world, and for the sake, the benefit, and the happiness of the great multitude of gods and humans, there is a Dharma discourse in the form of a dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Buddhas, spoken by the Tathāgatas,

arhats, perfectly awakened buddhas, as many as the grains of sand in the river Ganges.

Sons or daughters of noble family, whoever holds this Dharma discourse in the form of a dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Buddhas, or retains it, recites it, fully comprehends it, or expounds it extensively to others, or has faith in it, or devotes themselves to it with elevated intention, will never turn back from unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening. They will never be separated from the retention of all Dharmas. They will never be separated from the buddhas, the Blessed Ones. They will never be separated from seeing the Tathāgatas and from attending and honoring them. They will never be separated from hearing the Dharma. They will never be separated from serving the Saṅgha. They will bring the ocean of existence in saṃsāra to a halt, even though it has lasted for a thousand eons. Until they fully awaken to unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening, they will remember their past lives. Swiftly they will attain full and perfect buddhahood in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

All classes of spirits will protect them. Gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, and all beings, human and nonhuman, will be pleased with them. Illness will not take hold of their body. They will not meet death through harm from others. They will not die through punishment, through weapons, or through swallowing poison. The evil Māra will find no opening against them. The gods of Māra's retinue will find no opportunity. Wherever this is kept in mind, all those gods of Māra's retinue will be terrified, will tremble and quake, and will flee in the ten directions.

These words are the words of the buddhas. They are the great words of the buddhas. They are the great words permitted by the buddhas. They are the words of all the buddhas. They are the words of all the Tathāgatas.

Tadyathā: buddhe subuddhe, mahābuddhe, iha buddhe, tatra buddhe.

Buddhe buddhe, buddhamati, buddhe, sarvabuddha, anumati, sarvabuddha, anujñānate, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha, buddha.

The realm of the buddhas is boundless, and the teaching of the Dharma is likewise boundless. But what is to be taken up with single-pointed attention is, in brief, meditation. This dhāraṇī was spoken by all the buddhas out of compassion for sentient beings. It is the seal of all phenomena.

Tadyathā: śuddhe, suśuddhe, suśuddhe, śodhani, saṃśodhani, saṃśodhani, nirmale, mala apagata, gati samati krānti, krame samasare, sarāsara pari aśoke, viśoka, śokaśamani, śānte, upaśānte, praśānte, avabhāse, sarvapūṇya parimaṇḍite, sarvadharmā pratimaṇḍite, hara hara, mala hara, cara cara, saṃcara, cala cala saṃcala, tala tala, mātala, samātala, riṇe riṇe, suriṇe, samariṇe, riṇamati lokadhare, lokadhariṇe, dhara dhara, ḍara ḍara, rodha rodha, mahāvijaya vāhini, hana hana, sarvabuddhe, hrīpre śi, trasi, sarvajñāpathe, sarvajñāpāramite, mahāpratibhāna, saṃpanne, samanta, āloke buddha, viśaye, buddha, pratimaṇḍite, bhagavate, sara sara, prasara prasara, visara visara, prasara sarvaśoka apagata svāhā.

As soon as the Blessed One had spoken this Dharma discourse, the dhāraṇī of the heart of the buddhas, the mountains and the places that stood upon them shook, and the earth of this billionfold world system, the great thousand-fold world, shook, shook greatly, and shook in every direction. The great oceans were stirred, stirred greatly, and stirred in every direction. Even Sumeru, king of mountains, trembled and swayed. All the abodes of Māra were seized with terror. The gods of Māra's retinue and the evil Māra himself became deeply anguished and distressed, and were helpless.

Those beings who saw the great earth shake paid homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened buddha. They uttered three times the solemn exclamation: "Homage to the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly awakened buddha."

The gods who had faith in the buddha scattered divine flowers, māṇḍārava and great māṇḍārava, upon the Blessed One. Having scattered them, all those who took refuge in the buddha were filled with great joy. On that occasion this was said:

At the very instant that the Protector, the perfectly awakened Buddha, the Lion of the Śākyas,

Spoke these dhāraṇīs, the heart of all the buddhas,

In that very instant the earth shook in six ways.

The oceans were stirred, and all the abodes of Māra

Shook greatly, and the gods of Māra's retinue

Were thrown into terror and turmoil.

Māra, unhappy, was overwhelmed with suffering and grief.

Then the gods, hearing this wonder,

In order to make offerings to the Protector of the world,

Others who have faith in the Buddha
Offer jasmine, wreaths, and incense,
Powders, unguents, and garments,
Ornaments and armlets as well.

the ornament of rightly examining and analyzing, one by one, the teachings as they have been heard and as they have been understood; the ornament of non-apprehension of all phenomena, for the sake of fully maturing all sentient beings; the ornament of skill in means, which comes through the blessing of the buddhas; and the ornament of attaining dhāraṇī. These eight become the ornaments of the benefits of that person's good qualities.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, those bodhisattvas, the great beings, and those great hearers, together with the gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas of the world, rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

It was translated, revised, and finalized by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the great editor-translator, the venerable Yeshé Dé, and was corrected in accordance with the new terminology.

- The opening line, which says the text has been revised and settled on the basis of a new edition, is a colophon-style remark and is omitted. The Tibetan "ྐྱོད་ཀྱི་ཆུ་རྒྱུ་ལྟར་" (a numerical term,

a very large number) is rendered as "billions upon billions" for the sake of listening. The dhāraṇī at the end is rendered as it stands, with "buddhe subuddhe" taken as vocative forms; the original passage ends there, so the mantra may continue in the following portion. I did not translate the dhāraṇī itself.

- The mantra is given in a reconstructed Sanskrit form; the Tibetan transliteration contains some corrupt syllables (for example "hrīpre śi" and "riṇamati"), which I have left as they stand rather than emending. The passage breaks off mid-list, with four of the eight ornaments given. The phrase "billionfold world system" renders the standard "thousand of a thousand of a thousand" cosmology; "six ways" refers to the traditional six kinds of earthquake.
- The title is rendered literally from the Tibetan, Sangs rgyas kyi snying po, as Heart of the Buddhas; the Tibetan does not clarify whether "buddha" here is singular or plural in force. The phrase "passing the hand over the body" renders the Tibetan "to spread or cover with the hand," a ritual healing gesture. "Corrected in accordance with the new terminology" refers to the early ninth-century standardization of translation vocabulary (the skad gсар bcad revision), which gives the colophon its historical setting.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.